English: One-Night Guide

This guide is short on purpose. Each topic has a **memory hook** (one picture to remember it by), the key points, and a quick test with answers. Read one topic, then test yourself. Do not move on until you can say the hook from memory.

Time tonight	What to do
First 10 min	Read the 5-mark answer rule below. Learn it once.
Topic 1 (25 min)	Read, say the hook, do the test without looking.
Topic 2 (25 min)	Read, say the hook, do the test without looking.
Topic 3 (25 min)	Read, say the hook, do the test without looking.
Topic 4 (25 min)	Read, say the hook, do the test without looking.
Topic 5 (25 min)	Read, say the hook, do the test without looking.
Last 15 min	Read the golden lines. Say them out loud twice. Sleep.

The 5-mark rule: give 5 short numbered points, one line each. Start each point with a key word. Add one example if you can. That is all a 5-mark answer needs.

Topic 1: Communication Basics and Confidence

Memory hook: Communication is a ball bouncing back and forth. It goes from one person to another, and the reply bounces back.

Why it matters

- Academics: it stops confusion in projects.
- Teamwork: it helps people share work fairly.
- Internships and placements: it shows you are mature and ready.

Barriers and easy fixes

- Confidence and hesitation: people are not watching your mistakes as much as you think. Focus on the message.
- Fear of judgment: think of talk as a conversation, not a performance.
- Language anxiety: use simple words first.
- Assumptions: check by asking, 'So you mean...?'
- Lack of preparation: plan three points in two minutes.

The process (7 words)

Sender, Message, Channel, Receiver, Feedback, Context, Noise. Feedback is the reply. Noise is anything that blocks the message. Context is the situation.

How meaning is made

Verbal = your words. **Nonverbal** = eyes, posture, voice. **Listening** = understanding, not just hearing.

Quick test

1. Which word is the reply that shows understanding? *Answer: Feedback*

2. What blocks a message? *Answer: Noise*

3. Which fear makes people stop asking questions? *Answer: Fear of judgment*

4. Name the three meaning-makers. *Answer: Verbal, nonverbal, listening*

5. How do you fix assumptions? *Answer: Ask a check question, paraphrase*

Topic 2: Public Speaking

Memory hook: Breathe, Plan, Open, Points, Close. Five steps, one breath each.

Stage fear

- Signs: fast heartbeat, sweaty hands, dry mouth, fast breathing.
- Calm down: breathe in for 4 seconds, out for 6 seconds.
- It is energy. Use it, do not fight it.

Plan with AIM

- Audience: who are they?
- Purpose: what should they think or do?
- Message: one main idea.
- Level of detail: only enough to prove your point.

Structure

- Opening: a question, a surprising fact, or a short story. Never 'Hello, my name is...'
- Body: two or three connected points, each with an example.
- Close: one-sentence summary and a clear action.

Preparation and recovery

- Use keyword notes, not a full script.
- Practise out loud at least twice.
- If you lose your thread: pause for 2 seconds, say your last point again, then go on.

Quick test

1. What is the breathing pattern? *Answer: In for 4, out for 6*

2. What does AIM stand for? *Answer: Audience, Intent (purpose), Message*

3. What should a speech opening NOT start with? *Answer: Hello, my name is...*

4. What do you do if you lose your flow? *Answer: Pause 2 seconds, restate your last point*

Topic 3: Professional Emails and Clear Writing

Memory hook: Subject, Context, Request, Detail, Next step, Attachment, Sign-off. Say it like a shopping list: **S C R D N A S**.

Email parts (in order)

- Subject: clear and short, starts with the action, like '[Request] Report extension'.
- Context: one line saying why you are writing.
- Request: exactly what you need.
- Supporting detail: dates, numbers, reasons.
- Next step: the date and who does what.
- Attachment: name the file.
- Sign-off: polite close with your name.

Busy reader rule

Maximum 3 sentences per paragraph. Use bullets for 3 or more items.

Bad language to fix

- Inflated: 'effectuate a solution' becomes 'fix it'.
- Passive-aggressive: 'As per my email' becomes 'Could you reply by Friday?'
- Vague: 'soon' becomes 'by Thursday, 5 PM'.
- Rude: 'You did not send it' becomes 'It has not reached me. Could you resend it?'

Which emails you need

Requests, delays, extensions, help, mistakes, reminders, follow-ups. Each one: say the problem, say the fix, say the next step.

Email or call?

Email for records, files, and things that are not urgent. Call for conflict, emotion, or confusion.

Quick test

1. How many parts in an email? *Answer: Seven*

2. Which part names the file? *Answer: Attachment*

3. What is the maximum sentences per paragraph? *Answer: 3*

4. Better version of 'Soon, maybe'? *Answer: By Thursday, 5 PM*

5. Email or call for a heated disagreement? *Answer: Call*

Topic 4: Presentations

Memory hook: A report is read. A presentation is heard. Slides help you talk; they are not your script.

Report vs presentation

A report has full detail and the reader sets the pace. A presentation has a few main ideas and the speaker sets the pace.

Keep attention

- Start with a hook: a surprising number, a strange question, or a short story.
- One takeaway per slide.
- Use real examples.

Slides

- About 10 slides for a 20-minute talk.
- Titles at least 30 pt.
- Under 25 words per slide.
- Never read from the slide.

Impromptu: PREP

Point, **R**eason, **E**xample, **P**oint again.

Transitions and mistakes

- Transition: 'Before I move on, let me sum up.'
- Mistake: pause, fix it simply, carry on. Do not over-apologise.

Questions

Listen fully. Pause one second. Answer with a fact. If you do not know: **'I will check and send it to you.'**

Quick test

1. How many slides for 20 minutes? *Answer: About 10*

2. What is PREP? *Answer: Point, Reason, Example, Point*

3. Minimum title size? *Answer: 30 pt*

4. Max words per slide? *Answer: 25*

5. What do you say if you do not know an answer? *Answer: I will check and send it to you*

Topic 5: Workplace Messages and Tone

Memory hook: Right channel, right time, right tone. Keep the thread tidy, end with a decision.

Which channel?

- Email: formal, record, reply in 24 working hours.
- Direct message: urgent one-to-one, reply in 1 to 2 hours.
- Public channel: team-wide updates, end of day.
- Thread: one discussion, keeps the main feed clean.
- Call: blockers and sensitive issues, right away.

Urgency and follow-up

- Label urgent messages clearly.
- Do not send non-urgent messages late at night.
- Follow up once, politely, after the expected time: 'Just checking in on this.'
- If you are away: say when you will reply.

Status update: 4 parts
Completed, Obstacle, Support needed, Next step.

Threads and tags

- Keep the discussion in one thread.
- End with: decision, owner, due date.
- Tag only the people who must act.

Tone phrases

- Mistake: 'I found an error and have fixed it. The updated sheet is linked.'
- Competing priorities: 'I will finish X by 2 PM and Y by 6 PM.'
- Refusal: 'I cannot take this on this week. I can help next Monday.'
- Delay: 'It will be a day late because of a data issue. I will send it by 11 AM.'
- Help: 'Could you spare 15 minutes to look at this?'

Quick test

1. Which channel for an urgent one-to-one question? *Answer: Direct message*

2. What are the 4 parts of a status update? *Answer: Completed, obstacle, support needed, next step*

3. How should a long thread end? *Answer: With a decision, owner, and due date*

4. How do you follow up? *Answer: Once, politely, after the expected time*

5. Give one refusal phrase. *Answer: I cannot take this on this week. I can help next Monday.*

Golden Lines (say these out loud twice)

- Communication is a loop: sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback, context, noise.
- Breathe in 4, out 6. Stage fear is energy.
- Plan: audience, purpose, message, detail.
- Email: S C R D N A S (subject, context, request, detail, next step, attachment, sign-off).
- Max 3 sentences per paragraph.
- Presentation: 10 slides, 30 pt, 25 words, PREP.
- Status: completed, obstacle, support, next step.
- Unknown answer: 'I will check and send it to you.'
- Long thread: decision, owner, due date.

Final 5-question check (no looking)

1. Name the 7 steps of the communication process. *Answer: Sender, message, channel, receiver, feedback, context, noise*

2. Write the 7 email parts in order. *Answer: Subject, context, request, detail, next step, attachment, sign-off*

3. What is the breathing pattern for stage fear? *Answer: In for 4, out for 6*

4. What is PREP? *Answer: Point, reason, example, point*

5. Which channel for a team-wide update? *Answer: Public channel*

If you cannot answer a question in the check, go back to that topic and read it once more before sleeping.